

vision**2**learn

Business and Administration

Hints and Tips

Unit 1



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Hints and Tips Unit 1

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit one: Principles of personal responsibilities and working in a business environment

Section 1 - Know the employment rights and responsibilities of the employee and employer

Q1. Identify four main points that would be included in a contract of employment.

Here, you must list four main points that would be included in a contract of employment.

Q2a. & Q2b. In the table identify two types of legislation for employers (2a) and employees (2b) and then provide two key points of each legislation that affect employers/employees in a business environment.

This question is in two parts and you must name two key areas of legislation that affect the employer/employee and two key areas of legislation that affect the employer/employee. The legislation can be the same for both the employer and employee, but the key points will differ. [The legislation that you provide must be the latest with the correct/latest date included for the Act. Please check this.](#)

An example has been provided in the assessment to help you understand the difference between the legislation name and the key points. Please use alternative ones for your answers.

Q3. Identify a range of places where a person can find information on employment rights and responsibilities. You should identify two internal and two external sources of information.

Here, you must list two internal and two external sources of information on employment rights and responsibilities.

Q4. Describe how representative bodies can support employees.

In this question, you need to describe how representative bodies can support employees. A good source of information regarding trade unions can be found at www.tuc.org.uk

Q5. Identify employer and employee responsibilities for equality and diversity in a business environment. You should give at least two employer responsibilities and two employee responsibilities.

This question is in two parts - employer and employee responsibilities - and you must answer both parts to pass the question successfully. In addition to the learning materials, 'EHRC: Advice and Guidance' has some excellent information that can help you answer this question.

Q6. Using the table, provide three explanations for why equality and diversity procedures must be followed in a business environment. Your answer should include one benefit for the employer, one benefit for the employee and one benefit for the overall organisation.

This is a three-part question in which you need to include a benefit for the employer, the employee and the organisation as a whole.

Section 2 - All about health, safety and security

Q1a. Identify two employer and two employee responsibilities for **health and safety**.

This question is in two parts. You need to include both employer and employee responsibilities for health and safety. In addition to the course materials, www.hse.gov.uk provides useful information on employer and employee responsibilities for health and safety.

Q1b. Identify two employer and two employee responsibilities for **security**.

This question is in two parts. You need to include both employer and employee responsibilities for security. In addition to the course materials, www.hse.gov.uk provides useful information on employer and employee responsibilities for security.

Q2. Explain the purpose of following health, safety and security procedures in a business environment.

Why does managing health and safety properly make good business sense? In addition to the learning materials, a good article about this can be found at <http://www.healthandsafetyworksni.gov.uk/whymanagehealthandsafety>.

Q3. Describe three different ways of maintaining a safe and secure business environment.

List three different ways that a safe and secure environment can be maintained within a business.

Section 3 – Communicating effectively with others

Q1. Describe three different methods of communication. You should include one verbal, one non-verbal and one written method of communication.

Include one example for verbal, non-verbal and written communication. You should include a description of the communication methods you are using in your answer. It is not sufficient just to list the communication methods as your answer.

Q2. Using two specific examples, explain how to choose the most appropriate method of communication to meet your needs and the needs of others.

If you needed to speak with your Manager regarding a confidential issue, how would you approach them i.e. face-to-face, telephone, email? Would you approach them in private or in a public place where people can hear you?

Q3. Describe at least two ways of actively listening.

As well as using the course materials, a good article about active listening can be found at <http://www.mindtools.com/CommSkll/ActiveListening.htm>

Section 4 – Working with others

Q1. Explain two different purposes for agreeing standards for your own work.

You need to explain why 'having standards of work' is important, rather than listing different standards, such as 'must answer 10 telephone calls in an hour'. If you didn't have standards of work, how would you know if you are doing a good job or not? How will colleagues who depend on you know what to expect if you don't have standards?

Q2. Explain the purpose of taking on new challenges and being able to adapt to change at work.

If you're willing to take on new challenges, will this make you more valuable to the organisation or not? Will you learn new skills? If you resist new challenges and changes, how will your colleagues feel about you?

Q3. Explain the purpose of treating others with honesty and consideration.

If you are honest and respectful to your colleagues, how do you think this will affect the work environment? Will it help to build better working relationships or not? Also, how would you expect colleagues to behave towards you if you are unfriendly and unhelpful to them?

Section 5 – Planning your own work

Q1. Explain the purpose of meeting work standards and deadlines when completing tasks in a business environment.

Why is it important you meet the work standards required of you? What would the consequences of not meeting your work standards be?

Q2. Identify two different methods that you can use to plan your own work.

What tools and techniques can you use to plan your work? You need to describe two methods you can use to plan your work. A good source of time management tools and techniques can be found at http://www.mindtools.com/pages/main/newMN_HTE.htm.

Q3. Describe ways of keeping other people informed about progress and compare their effectiveness. Think about 2 separate times that you have had to inform other people about your own progress. In the box below describe both times and explain how well each one worked. Could you have done anything different?

You need to select two communication methods you could use to keep people informed of your work progress, i.e. face-to-face, telephone, email, meetings and describe how effective each one is.

Section 6 – Improving your performance

Q1. Explain the purpose of continuously improving your performance in a business environment.

Here, you must explain the purpose of continuously improving your performance in a business environment. What benefits does it bring to the business and the employee? It is not enough to just list your answers; you must give your answers and then expand upon them with further reasoning as to the benefits of continuously improving your performance.

Q2. Describe two ways of improving your performance at work. If relevant, you may use examples from your own work experience.

You need to give specific examples of how you can improve your performance at work. Could you do extra training, work shadowing, have a coach/mentor at work or use a learning plan? You need to describe how these steps could improve your performance at work.

Q3. Identify two different types of career pathways or options that may be available to you. If relevant, this may be with your current employer or another pathway that you wish to pursue.

What types of career could you do? Could you move up in your current career? Could you move to a different career? Be specific with your answer and describe how you would move along the career pathway.

Section 7 – Problems at work

Q1. In the table, first Identify two different types of problems that can occur in a business environment, then explain how the problems can be dealt with, finally explain how and when each problem should be referred to colleagues.

This question covers 3 learning outcomes:

You must identify at least two types of problems that can occur in a business environment. You should include at least one minor problem and one major problem.

When explaining how to deal with the problem, think about the examples on Page 2 of the course materials. Try and think of your own examples then explain how you, or the organisation, could deal with each one. Think about who might be able to help and what knowledge or experience would be useful when dealing with these issues. Each explanation should be at least 50 words long.

Finally, think about who is best placed to fix this problem and why. Then explain, how you could transfer any problems to other relevant people. How and when would you do this? Would it be done verbally, or would you have to complete a form or send a recorded email?